

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1099

By Jones J

A RESOLUTION to recognize and honor Pam Weston for her lifetime of devoted service to the citizens of Tennessee.

WHEREAS, it is most fitting that the members of this General Assembly should acknowledge and applaud those community leaders who are wholly devoted to enhancing the quality of life for their fellow citizens and improving and enriching the place they all call home; and

WHEREAS, one such noteworthy person is Pam Weston of Sweetwater, who has distinguished herself as a citizen of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Weston has lived a full, rich life devoted to serving others through various causes she believes in; she has been so much to so many—a beloved teacher and mentor; a justice-minded political, arts, environmental, and healthcare advocate; and a dear friend; and

WHEREAS, a 1974 graduate of Sweetwater High School, Ms. Weston attended Hiwassee College and earned a Bachelor of Science degree and Master of Science degree in Mathematics from East Tennessee State University (ETSU); she was inducted into Phi Kappa Phi honor society as an undergraduate in the top five percent of her class; and

WHEREAS, Pam Weston has worked as a full-time contract faculty member at ETSU, the University of West Georgia (UWG), Pellissippi State Community College, and Tennessee Wesleyan University (TWU); during her distinguished tenure, she has reviewed texts, conducted seminars, and coauthored a number of original research articles; and

WHEREAS, while at ETSU, she worked with the political science department to conduct a case study on three Tennessee Superfund sites: Bumpas Cove, Red Ridge Landfill, and Fowler Mine; this work was inspired by her having grown up near a Superfund site and

witnessing the resultant harm to her working class, rural community—an experience that helped shape her advocacy work; and

WHEREAS, in support of the well-being of her fellow citizens, Pam Weston served as a member of the Monroe Health Council, Tennessee Health Care Coalition, and District 9 Coalition for Insure Tennessee; a mentor with Tennessee Promise and New Leaders Council; and treasurer of 3M Indivisible McMinn Meigs Monroe; and

WHEREAS, her deep love for the arts led her to coordinate art workshops and events, leading to the opportunity for her to serve as the lead artist on a children's international art exchange; she also served as membership coordinator and advisory board member for the Artists Association of Monroe County and an advisory board member for the Marcella Center for the Arts and Education; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Weston is passionate about governance and has worked for many years to foster local connections and collaborations; she has held various leadership roles within the Tennessee Democratic Party, Monroe County Democratic Women, Progressive Rural Overhill Women for Democracy, and the Tennessee Federation of Democratic Women, in addition to running for local office and supporting the campaigns of fellow Democrats; and

WHEREAS, Pam Weston has been duly honored for her many contributions as an educator, receiving the Distinguished Faculty Service Award from UWG Disability Services and being nominated at TWU for the Thompson Award for Teaching Excellence; and

WHEREAS, she has also been recognized in her community, earning the Hometown Hero Award from the Tennessee Justice Center and the Health Care Hero Award from the Tennessee Health Care Campaign and being named Woman of the Year by the Monroe County Democratic Women's Club; and

WHEREAS, Pam Weston's devotion to the arts has been recognized by the Johnson City Division of Parks and Recreation, with the Arts & Humanities Award, and the Kennedy Center, with the National Award for Excellence in Leadership in the Arts; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Weston has built a legacy of kindness, compassion, and tireless service, and her indelible contributions to her students, her community, and this State will continue to inspire others for years to come; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we recognize and honor Pam Weston for her lifetime of devoted service to the citizens of Tennessee, extending our sincerest gratitude for her compassionate mentorship, leadership, and advocacy.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.